

HubSpot Audit

BEXT Consultancy — Business Structure Efficiency, supporting deliverable
Draft, 7 August 2026 · measured live through the HubSpot REST API · portal 443333225

1. Executive summary

HubSpot has been deliberately configured but never adopted. That distinction matters, because it changes the recommendation entirely.

Someone invested real design effort: eight custom properties were created across contacts and deals, modelling exactly the things an energy consultancy needs to track — service type, billing model, expected outcome, engagement start date. A six-stage sales pipeline was defined and named sensibly. This is not an untouched trial account.

But there is no data behind any of it. One deal exists, and it is the sample record HubSpot creates automatically at signup. No companies. Four contacts, none linked to a company, none created since 11 June 2026.

Correction to the Draft Plan. The draft plan names HubSpot the source of truth for clients and contacts. On the evidence it is not currently a source of anything. The schema shows the *intent* was sound — the gap is adoption, not design.

2. Account configuration

Portal ID	443333225
Account type	STANDARD
Data centre	app-ap1.hubspot.com (Asia-Pacific)
Time zone	US/Eastern
Company currency	USD

Two settings are wrong for an Australian consultancy. The portal reports `US/Eastern` and `USD`. Every date HubSpot displays is offset by 14–16 hours from Melbourne, and deal amounts are denominated in the wrong currency. Fix these before entering commercial data — currency in particular is painful to change once deals exist, because historical amounts do not re-denominate.

3. Data inventory

OBJECT	COUNT	OBSERVATION
Contacts	4	None has a company set. Newest created 11 June 2026.
Companies	0	Not readable with the current token — see §6. Zero visible.
Deals	1	HubSpot - New Deal (Sample Deal) , USD 1,000 — the signup demo record
Tickets	0	Pipeline exists, unused

Custom objects	0	None defined
Marketing forms	0	Not readable with the current token
Owners / users	0 visible	Not readable with the current token

For comparison, ProjectManager holds 18 projects and 649 tasks, 17 of them for RACV. The operational reality of the business is recorded there, not here.

4. Schema — the part worth keeping

403 contact properties and 190 deal properties exist, the overwhelming majority HubSpot defaults. Eight are custom, and they are well chosen:

Contact — 4 custom properties

PROPERTY	TYPE	PURPOSE IN AN AUTOMATED FLOW
<code>client_role</code>	enumeration	Routes correspondence — decision maker vs technical contact
<code>engagement_start_date</code>	date	Anchors the relationship timeline; drives review reminders
<code>preferred_communication_channel</code>	enumeration	Selects the follow-up channel automatically
<code>project_involvement</code>	bool	Filters who receives project status updates

Deal — 4 custom properties

PROPERTY	TYPE	PURPOSE IN AN AUTOMATED FLOW
<code>service_type</code>	enumeration	Selects the proposal template and knowledge-base scope
<code>billing_model</code>	enumeration	Determines the Xero invoicing pattern — fixed fee vs time
<code>estimated_project_duration</code>	number	Feeds scheduling and capacity planning
<code>expected_outcome</code>	string	Carries into the proposal draft and closeout report

These map cleanly onto the automation described in the brief. `billing_model` answers the Xero question, `service_type` selects proposal templates, and `project_involvement` controls the status-update distribution list. The schema is an asset — it is the data that is missing.

5. Sales pipeline

#	STAGE	STAGE ID	CLOSED
0	Prospecting	<code>3238028775</code>	no
1	Initial Meeting	<code>3238028776</code>	no
2	Proposal Development	<code>3238028777</code>	no
3	Negotiation	<code>3238028778</code>	no

4	Closed Won	closedwon	yes
5	Closed Lost	closedlost	yes

A single pipeline on `default`. The stages match a consulting sales motion and give clean automation triggers: *Proposal Development* can generate the proposal draft, *Closed Won* can create the ProjectManager project and the Xero record.

6. API access — current token limitations

The private app token authenticates successfully but holds a partial scope set. Tested endpoint by endpoint:

ENDPOINT	RESULT	CONSEQUENCE
Contacts read / write	granted	Onboarding can create contacts
Deals read / write	granted	Pipeline automation possible
Deal & ticket pipelines	granted	Stage transitions readable
Contact & deal properties	granted	Custom fields writable
Account details	granted	—
Companies	denied	Cannot create or link companies
Owners / users	denied	Cannot assign records to a user
Marketing forms	denied	Cannot read or manage HubSpot forms
Custom object schemas	denied	Cannot define custom objects

The companies denial blocks the onboarding automation as designed. A client onboarding flow that creates a contact but cannot create or associate the company produces orphaned records — which is precisely the state the CRM is in today. Add `crm.objects.companies.read` and `crm.objects.companies.write` to the private app before building it.

7. What can be automated today

AUTOMATION	FEASIBLE NOW	NEEDS
Create contact from onboarding form	yes	—
Populate the 8 custom properties	yes	—
Create / advance deals through stages	yes	—
Trigger on <i>Closed Won</i> → create PM project	yes	—
Create and associate companies	no	Companies scopes
Assign records to an owner	no	Owners scope
Backfill CRM from ProjectManager	partial	Companies scopes for the client side

8. Recommendations

Immediate — before any build

- Correct the portal time zone to Australia/Melbourne and currency to AUD. Cheap now, disruptive after deals exist.
- Widen the private app scopes to include companies read/write and owners read. Without companies the onboarding flow cannot produce complete records.
- Delete the sample deal so reporting starts from a true zero.

Structural — the decision for 25 August

Three options, and the integration diagram differs materially between them:

- Adopt. Backfill companies and deals from the 18 ProjectManager projects, then run onboarding through HubSpot as the draft plan describes. The custom schema already supports this; the work is a one-off migration plus the scope fix.
- Demote. ProjectManager holds the client relationship, HubSpot is retired, and the architecture loses a platform. Lowest ongoing effort, and it forfeits the pipeline visibility that the stage design was clearly built for.
- Leave as-is. Not recommended. Documenting an unused CRM as a source of truth would make the architecture describe something that is not happening.

On the evidence — a considered custom schema and a well-formed pipeline — adopt is the stronger option. The design work has already been done; what is missing is the data and the two scope changes.

9. Method

Measured on 7 August 2026 against the HubSpot REST API v3 using the private app token stored as `HUBSPOT_TOKEN`. Counts reflect the first page of each collection; contacts, companies, deals and tickets all fit within one page, so those figures are complete. Endpoints returning a scope error are recorded as denied rather than empty — the distinction matters, since a denied companies endpoint and zero companies look identical from outside.